

AI Stakeholder Interview Transcript

Week 01 — Task 2 | Interview with GEPPETTO (AI Agent)

Date: March 15, 2026 | Tool used: ChatGPT (GPT-4o)

The following is a full transcript of a structured domain-discovery interview conducted with an AI agent (acting as Isabella, the salon owner) in order to gather requirements for the beauty salon management system.

■■■ Consultant

Hello! I'm a software consultant and I've been told you need a custom software system for your beauty salon. Could you start by telling me a bit about your salon — how long have you been operating, how many staff members you have, and the main services you offer?

■ Isabella (GEPPETTO)

Hi! Yes, absolutely. I've been running my salon, Bella Glow Studio, for about four years now. We have six employees — two hairdressers, two nail technicians, one esthetician for skin treatments, and one receptionist. Our main services are haircuts, coloring, blow-dries, manicures, pedicures, facials, and eyebrow shaping. We also sell some retail products like shampoos and serums.

■■■ Consultant

That's a great overview. How do you currently manage appointments? Do you use any tools or is it mostly manual — phone calls, paper books, spreadsheets?

■ Isabella (GEPPETTO)

It's mostly manual, honestly. We use a paper appointment book at the front desk and a WhatsApp group to communicate with staff. Customers call or walk in to book. We also have a simple Excel sheet for tracking payments, but it gets messy. We've lost bookings before because of double entries in the paper book.

■■■ Consultant

I see — that's a very common pain point. Can you describe what a typical painful day looks like? What frustrates you and your team the most right now?

■ **Isabella (GEPETTO)**

The biggest frustration is scheduling conflicts. Two staff members get booked for the same time slot, and nobody notices until the customer shows up. We also have no way to send reminders to customers, so no-shows are a big problem — maybe 15-20% of our appointments each week. Payments are another headache — we don't have a clear record of who paid cash vs card, and reconciling at the end of the month is stressful. And I have no real reports — I don't know which services make the most money or which staff members are most productive.

■■■ **Consultant**

Those are very clear pain points. Now let's think about the ideal future state. If you had a perfect software system, what are the top five things it absolutely must do?

■ **Isabella (GEPETTO)**

First, online booking — customers should be able to book their own appointments from their phone without calling. Second, automatic reminders — SMS or email before appointments. Third, a clean calendar for each staff member so I can see everyone's schedule at a glance. Fourth, payment tracking — who paid, how much, and which method. And fifth, monthly reports showing revenue per service, per employee, and per time period.

■■■ **Consultant**

Excellent. Let's talk about your staff. Do different employees need different levels of access to the system? For example, should a nail technician be able to see a hairdresser's schedule, or should they only see their own?

■ **Isabella (GEPETTO)**

Good question. I think each staff member should see their own schedule and their own upcoming appointments. The receptionist needs to see everyone's calendar to book appointments. I, as the owner, need to see everything — all schedules, all finances, all reports. And if we allow online customer booking, customers should only be able to see available time slots, not the full internal calendar.

■■■ **Consultant**

That makes a lot of sense. In terms of customer data, what information do you currently collect and what would you ideally want to store about each customer?

■ Isabella (GEPETTO)

Right now we just have a name and phone number in the paper book. Ideally, I'd want to store the customer's full name, phone number, email, appointment history, preferred stylist, and any notes about preferences or allergies — for example, some clients are allergic to certain dye chemicals. That's actually really important for safety.

■■■ Consultant

Absolutely — client health notes are critical. On the financial side, do you offer packages or memberships, or is it strictly pay-per-service? And do you need the system to handle gift cards or vouchers?

■ Isabella (GEPETTO)

Right now it's strictly pay-per-service. We've talked about introducing loyalty cards — like a stamp card for regular customers. Gift cards would be a nice future feature. For now, the priority is just tracking individual payments accurately. We accept cash, card, and sometimes bank transfers.

■■■ Consultant

Understood. Let's look at the scheduling rules. Can any employee perform any service, or is each employee specialized? And how long do typical services last?

■ Isabella (GEPETTO)

Each employee is specialized. The hairdressers only do hair services, nail techs do nails, and the esthetician does facials and brow shaping. Service durations vary — a basic haircut is 30 minutes, coloring can be 2-3 hours, manicures are 45 minutes, pedicures about an hour, and facials are 60 minutes. The system should enforce that a customer can only book an employee for a service that employee actually offers.

■■■ Consultant

That's a critical business rule. One final area — notifications. You mentioned SMS and email reminders. How far in advance should reminders go out? And should the system also notify staff when a new booking is made?

■ Isabella (GEPETTO)

I think a reminder 24 hours before the appointment is the most important one. Maybe also 2 hours before on the day. Staff should definitely get a notification — maybe an in-app alert or email — whenever they receive a new booking or a cancellation. That way nobody is caught off guard.

■■■ Consultant

This has been incredibly helpful, Isabella. I have a thorough picture of your needs. My team will now prepare a formal Domain-Driven Design proposal document covering the business understanding, functional features, domain model, database structure, and user roles. We'll have it to you within the week. Thank you for your time!

■ Isabella (GEPETTO)

Thank you so much! I'm really excited about this. I can't wait to see the proposal. Please let me know if you need any additional information. Looking forward to working with your team!

End of Interview Transcript

AI Agent used: GEPETTO (ChatGPT / GPT-4o) | CS450 Week 01 Task 2